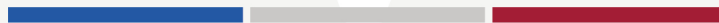




MIT SLOAN SCHOOL OF MANAGEMENT
MIT SCHWARZMAN COLLEGE OF COMPUTING



MODULE 2 UNIT 2
Media Set Video 4 Transcript

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Managing humans and agents

PAUL MCDONAGH-SMITH: Let's flip the lens here a little bit. What about the frontier? We've been touching upon this, but explicitly. What about the frontier of what leaders need to be able to do? So managing a workforce that includes autonomous agents, systems that plan, systems that act, systems that can adapt. I'd suggest it requires capabilities that not all leadership development programs have yet contemplated.

So we're talking about leaders who need to design, redesign human agent workflows, make judgment calls about where to trust machine autonomy, govern systems they can't fully inspect, evolve, build cultures where people and agents genuinely complement each other rather than compete. And so from your vantage point, given the dimensions of this conversation as what are the critical management and leadership capabilities that you think are necessary for operating effectively at today's frontier? And where is the widest gap or where is the gap widest between what leaders can do today and what will be required of them tomorrow morning type of idea.

KANCHANA PATLOLLA: So actually, whether the management leader, no matter who you are, there is this new coined word which is evolving, I don't know if you've heard of it yet, the agent managers. Everyone is a agent manager. Like, you would have a set of four or five agents which would be doing your job, and then it's taking care of your efforts, and you are kind of the the manager for it. But when you think about like, leaving this alone, what we know today with respect to agents and the management leadership program-wise, career-wise growth, if you think about it. Most of the times, in the past, any transformation which we have gone through with respect to mobile or prior to that, even with the internet, the adoption curve, was, like, longer, in nature. And, like, I remember 2007 was the first smartphone.

MCDONAGH-SMITH: Yeah. Yeah.

PATLOLLA: But many web applications did not have a mobile app till about, like, 2011, 2012, like, I would say. So that's about, like, five, six years. But when you think about today, it is not the expectation. The expectation is quicker. So, like, for me, the first principle right now is what it is you could do to go to market quicker. And that go to market quicker comes based on your trusted people who can do things quicker. It's, unfortunately, the world we live in is no longer has that time frame in my mind for doing things smaller and shorter. People are, like, I've observed this too, people are okay for in certain places, not for all the use cases, of course, I should say that. But for some use cases, even if it's not the perfect answer, they're okay to have that experience.

So what I'm trying to say is go to market quicker is for me the biggest management thing which we have to do right now, because that concept of it needs your workforce, because your team needs to be very nimble. They need to be adaptive. We talked about, you know, how you cannot be tied to one platform, how you cannot be. They need to be this niche people who are executing and who are able to show outcomes, because we can't be having

slow delivery in some regards in this this arena. At least from where I sit, that's the way I'm looking at things.

Then the second place of it, when I think about, you know, the management and the leadership, of how it evolves, picking the right use case sometimes is a sent to, like, you know, people who are, you know, technical in nature. But I don't know if it's the right move. I think it's a business, decision. What is the smallest thing which you can do to be able to do it?

Then the third thing, if I think about how the workforce and where you are, encouraged to learn, to share, and to move together as an organization. That's one thing which I felt like Google does this very well. We have some sessions called AI for Cloud AI. I belong to the Cloud AI team, and we have AI for Cloud AI. That's very important because we all have this fatigue. I learn, like, I do this all day everyday. So I hear about products. I know the tools, but I don't have a hands on experience. Yep. So encouraging the teams to learn, to share. It could be a simple thing. It could be like share your prompt of what you're doing. Like, you know, we have a prompt which is like, how do you, you know, get the review done by the senior executive? And we know exactly the questions they would ask. And we have created a prompt. So every document which goes through goes through that prompt to make sure we get the review done. So these kind of simple things, I think you should encourage your team to be able to do it.

SPEAKER: Did you understand all the concepts covered in this video? If you'd like to review any of the content, please click on the chapter menu.